movement and lower caste mobilisation in India. In this regard, see, for example, his body of work: *The Hindu Nationalist Movement and Indian Politics: 1925 to the 1990s* (New Delhi: Penguin, 1999, first published 1996); his *India's Silent Revolution: The Rise of Low Castes in North Indian Politics* (New Delhi: Permanent Black, 2003); and a collection of his essays published in *Religion, Caste & Politics in India* (New Delhi: Primus, 2010).

4. Jaffrelot and Vernier produced their analysis working with researchers at the Trivedi Centre for Political Data (Ashoka University) and CERI (Sciences Po, Paris) using data from SPINPER (The Social Profile of the Indian National and Provincial Elected Representatives) project. Christophe Jaffrelot, Gilles Verniers, 'Explained: In Hindi heartland, upper castes dominate new Lok Sabha', *The Indian Express*, 27 May 2019, https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/in-hindi-heartland-upper-castes-dominate-new-house-5747511/.
5. Christophe Jaffrelot, Gilles Verniers, 'Explained: In Hindi heartland, upper castes dominate new Lok Sabha', *The Indian Express*, 27 May 2019, https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/in-hindi-heartland-upper-castes-dominate-new-house-5747511/.
6. Christophe Jaffrelot, Gilles Verniers, 'The reconfiguration of India's political elite: Profiling the 17th Lok Sabha', Contemporary South Asia, Vol. 28, No. 2, 18 May 2020, pp. 242–254, https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/full/10.1080/09584935.2020.1765984.
7. They used data from SPINPER project co-funded by Trivedi Centre for Political Data (Ashoka University); CNRS, France; CERI and University of Bordeaux.
8. Upper-caste Rajputs are commonly referred to as Thakurs in the Hindi heartland.
9. Interview with Tarit Prakash, VMR, 1 June 2020.
10. SC data is from Census of India 2011. OBC data is from NSSO Report No. 563: *Employment and Unemployment Situation among Social Groups*, 2011-12. Quoted in Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Government of India, *Handbook on Social Welfare Statistics 2018* (New Delhi: Department of Social